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OWASP ZAP:

Its also called Zed Attack Proxy.

ZAP is an **intercepting proxy + automated vulnerability scanner** used to find security flaws in web applications.

Browser ⇌ ZAP Proxy ⇌ Target Web Application

To start ZAP you have to first select a mode and the modes are given below:

Mode	Active Scan	Scope Restricted	Automatic Attacks	Risk Level
Safe	✗ No	N/A	✗ No	Very Low
Protected	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✗ No	Controlled
Standard	✓ Yes	✗ No	✗ No	Medium
Attack	✓ Yes	✗ No (auto)	✓ Yes	High

Now how to define scope in the ZAP:

1. Open ZAP
2. Select protected mode
3. Open the ZAP Browser
4. Search for URL
5. Now come back to ZAP and Right click on your URL
6. Select >>> include in context-----> Default-----> Add

7. Now click on the icon

The screenshot shows the ZAP 2.17.0 interface. On the left, the 'Sites' list is expanded, showing a list of URLs. The URL 'https://www.education.gov.in' is selected and highlighted in blue. A blue circle highlights the 'Sites' icon in the top-left toolbar. On the right, a 'Welcome' message is displayed, stating: 'ZAP is an easy to use integrated penetration testing tool for finding vuln. If you are new to ZAP then it is best to start with one of the options below.' Below the message is a logo for 'Automated Sc' and a link 'Learn all about'. At the bottom, the 'History' tab is active, showing a list of requests with columns for Channel, Timestamp, and Opcode.

Channel	Timestamp	Opcode
#1.106	26/02/2026, 15:50:05.78	1=TEXT
#1.107	26/02/2026, 15:50:05.133	1=TEXT
#1.108	26/02/2026, 15:50:09.747	1=TEXT
#1.109	26/02/2026, 15:50:11.294	1=TEXT
#1.110	26/02/2026, 15:50:17.277	1=TEXT
#1.111	26/02/2026, 15:50:18.426	1=TEXT
#1.112	26/02/2026, 15:50:18.893	1=TEXT
#1.113	26/02/2026, 15:50:19.359	1=TEXT
#1.114	26/02/2026, 15:50:19.446	1=TEXT
#1.115	26/02/2026, 15:50:19.762	1=TEXT

Now you have successfully defined the scope and now you can do anything with the “in-scope” URL.

If you want to add all the sub-domains related to a domain to “in context” then `https://*.education.gov.in`

^ here the * means all the sites related to the education.gov.in